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NOTICE OF HAZARDOUS ENCROACHMENT & ASSET THREAT: Subterranean High-Pressure Gas/Oil Pipeline Alignment (Chicago Avenue Slope, Yorba Linda) — Immediate Action Required

1 message

lmad <lmad.compliance.review@gmail.com> Thu, Oct 29, 2026 at 10:00 AM
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Subject: NOTICE OF HAZARDOUS ENCROACHMENT & ASSET THREAT: Subterranean High-Pressure Gas/Oil Pipeline Alignment (Chicago Avenue Slope, Yorba Linda) — Immediate Action Required

TO CORPORATE LEGAL COUNSEL AND ASSET PROTECTION DIVISION

CALIFORNIA RESOURCES CORPORATION (NYSE: CRC):

This communication serves as a formal **Notice of Hazardous Encroachment, Pipeline Vulnerability, and Environmental Asset Hazard** regarding California Resources Corporation's high-pressure natural gas/oil gathering pipeline infrastructure situated along the Chicago Avenue slope corridor in Yorba Linda, California.

1. Asset Ownership & Title / Easement Structure

Following CRC's acquisition and merger with Aera Energy LLC, CRC holds subsurface mineral rights and operates high-pressure transmission/gathering pipeline facilities traversing the toe of the slope on Chicago Avenue. Based on title and engineering review:

> **Asset Owner:** California Resources Corporation (NYSE: CRC) operates the un-easemented subterranean high-pressure pipeline facilities along the toe of the slope.
>
> **Landscape Easement Holder:** The City of Yorba Linda holds merely a **limited landscape maintenance access easement** over the slope parcel.
>
> **Fee Owner:** Title rests with the underlying deed owner; no dedicated public road right-of-way encumbers the slope parcel.

2. Operational Hazard, Historic WUI Classification, & Regulatory Exposure

The slope directly above CRC's subterranean pipeline alignment represents a functional Wildland-Urban Interface (WUI) corridor, densely overgrown with an unmitigated forest of invasive pine and pepper trees.

While municipal authorities have attempted to cite the administrative removal of the Very High Fire Hazard Severity Zone (VHFHSZ) overlay as an excuse for inaction, municipal planning records—including the historical development entitlements, Environmental Impact Reports (EIRs), and conditions of approval for the **Vista Del Verde (VDV)** project on this exact slope parcel—explicitly recognized this fuel bed as a hazardous fire boundary threatening the adjoining pre-1980 non-fire-resistant homes along Chicago Avenue.

This unmitigated fuel load presents immediate operational threats to CRC's pipeline integrity and regulatory compliance under **CPUC General Order 112-F** and **49 CFR Part 192**:

> **Subgrade Soil & Coating Degradation:** Invasive root systems wrap around and destabilize subgrade soil surrounding CRC's high-pressure main, compromising protective pipe coatings and obstructing emergency excavation access.

Catastrophic Thermal Exposure: The continuous canopy creates an unbroken fuel ladder and slope convection chimney less than 100 feet from legacy residential structures and VDV homes immediately above. In a wildland-urban interface fire event, extreme radiant heat directly over CRC's alignment threatens catastrophic pipeline rupture and ignition.

Impaired Fire Apparatus Staging: Active violations of **OCFA Fire Prevention Guideline B-09** block emergency vehicle staging, ensuring responding crews cannot safely position 75,000-lb Type 1 engines along the Chicago Avenue pipeline corridor during an active interface fire.

3. Municipal Default & Immunity Voided

The City of Yorba Linda was served a formal Notice of Strict Liability on October 26, 2026, and officially acknowledged receipt via Assistant City Clerk Carolina Torres (proof attached). The City's administrative default (October 14, 2026) has expired without corrective action. Actual knowledge under **CA Government Code § 835** is perfected, voiding municipal immunity.

4. Demand for Corporate Asset Protection Intervention

As an Investor-Owned Entity subject to CPUC Safety and Enforcement Division (SED) oversight, CRC has an affirmative obligation under state and federal pipeline safety codes to protect its pipeline corridor.

We respectfully demand that CRC Corporate Legal and Risk Management immediately:

Issue a Formal Facility Protection & Encroachment Demand to the City Manager and City Attorney of Yorba Linda, compelling the City to immediately abate the hazardous tree roots and fuel load managed under their landscape maintenance easement.

Coordinate with CPUC SED (Commission File No. 753993) to enforce pipeline corridor protection standards pursuant to CPUC GO 112-F.

Notify Local Operations to conduct an immediate pipeline integrity and root-encroachment field audit along the Chicago Avenue alignment.

Failure by municipal authorities or utility asset holders to abate this public nuisance will result in lawful private self-help abatement proceeding under **California Civil Code §§ 3495 & 3502**.

Technical Evidentiary Package & Audit Ledger:

20-Second Technical Video Evidence: https://youtu.be/9Cw6u9K-664

Immutable Public Audit Ledger: https://github.com/ca-lmad-auditors/yorba-linda-lmad-compliance-audit

Respectfully submitted,

LMAD Compliance Review

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A Public Safety & Infrastructure Audit Group